

STOREFRONT GUIDE

The Storefront Launch Checklist

Everything to get right before you open your online storefront to real customers — in the order it actually matters.

Storefront Guide · Updated April 2026

For: solo sellers and new retail businesses

Published by XYVOO — hotel management and storefront software. This guide is provided for general information and reflects practices we've seen work across the properties and shops we support; treat figures and thresholds as a starting point to adapt to your own operation.

Launch in the right order

Most launch checklists are just a long, unordered list, which means the easy, unimportant items (choosing a font) get done first and the items that actually stop a sale (a broken checkout) get discovered by your first real customer. This guide is ordered by what actually breaks a launch, not by how easy each step is.

1. Can a customer actually pay you?

Before anything else — test this, with a real card, not a test key.

- ☐ Complete one real, small purchase yourself, start to finish, on both desktop and mobile.
- ☐ Confirm the payment shows up in your Paystack dashboard and the order shows up in your storefront at the same time.
- ☐ Check what a customer sees if a payment fails or their card is declined — it should be clear, not a dead end.
- ☐ Confirm you receive an order notification you'll actually see (email or dashboard) the moment an order comes in.

2. Can they find what they're looking for?

- ☐ Every product has at least one clear photo, an accurate price, and a description written for a customer, not a supplier catalogue.
- ☐ Out-of-stock items are marked as such, not just hidden — a customer who can't find a product they saw advertised assumes something's broken.
- ☐ Categories or collections group products the way a customer thinks about them, not the way you organise your storeroom.
- ☐ Search actually finds products by the words a customer would type, not just the exact product title.

3. Will the order actually reach them?

- ☐ Shipping or delivery options are set for every area you actually serve, with a price and time estimate that's true, not aspirational.
 - ☐ A customer gets a confirmation the moment they order, and an update when it ships — silence between order and delivery is the single biggest driver of 'where is my order' messages.
 - ☐ Returns and exchange terms are written down somewhere a customer can find before they buy, not just when they ask.
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4. Does it look like a real business?

- ☐ A real business name, contact email and phone number are visible — not just a contact form.
- ☐ Product photos are consistent in size and background — a mismatched set reads as unfinished even if the products are good.
- ☐ The storefront works on a phone without pinching to zoom — most first-time visitors will be on one.

5. Can you actually run it day to day?

The parts a customer never sees are the parts that determine whether you can keep this running past week one.

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The soft-launch trick

WORTH DOING

Share the link with 10–15 people you know before any paid advertising — friends, family, existing customers from another channel. It surfaces the checkout and shipping problems above with people who'll forgive a rough edge, before a stranger encounters the same problem and simply leaves.

How XYVOO helps

XYVOO Storefront brings catalogue, checkout, Paystack payments and order management into one dashboard, so most of this checklist is a configuration step rather than a separate tool to wire up — and the parts worth testing by hand (section 1 above) are exactly the parts we'd recommend testing regardless of what you build on.

